

SOC L1 Readiness Test (MCQ with Options, Answers & Explanations)

Section A — Multiple Choice Questions

1. *What is the primary role of a SOC L1 analyst?*

- A. Develop malware
- B. Monitor alerts and perform initial triage
- C. Write security policies
- D. Perform penetration testing

2. *Which malware encrypts files and demands payment?*

- A. Trojan
- B. Worm
- C. Ransomware
- D. Spyware

3. *Which attack uses one password across many accounts?*

- A. Brute Force
- B. Dictionary Attack
- C. Password Spraying
- D. Credential Stuffing

4. *What does hashing primarily provide?*

- A. Confidentiality
- B. Integrity
- C. Authentication
- D. Availability

5. *What does salting prevent?*

- A. Brute force attacks
- B. Rainbow table attacks
- C. Phishing attacks
- D. DDoS attacks

6. *Which tool is commonly used for credential dumping?*

- A. Wireshark
- B. Metasploit
- C. Mimikatz

D. Burp Suite

7. Which Windows process stores credentials in memory?

- A. svchost.exe
- B. explorer.exe
- C. lsass.exe
- D. winlogon.exe

8. Which attack redirects users to a fake website without clicking a malicious link?

- A. Phishing
- B. Pharming
- C. Smishing
- D. Baiting

9. Moving from one compromised machine to another inside a network is called?

- A. Privilege escalation
- B. Persistence
- C. Lateral movement
- D. Data exfiltration

10. Which encryption type uses two keys?

- A. Symmetric encryption
- B. Asymmetric encryption
- C. Hashing
- D. Encoding

11. Which attack involves fraudulent emails to steal credentials?

- A. Phishing
- B. Malware
- C. DDoS
- D. SQL Injection

12. What does IOC stand for?

- A. Indicator of Compromise
- B. Incident of Crime
- C. Internal Operations Control
- D. Internet Operations Center

13. Which attack uses previously leaked credentials from breaches?

- A. Brute force
- B. Credential stuffing

- C. Password spraying
- D. Dictionary attack

14. Which attack floods servers with traffic to disrupt services?

- A. Malware
- B. Phishing
- C. DDoS
- D. Brute Force

15. Which technique steals password hashes from memory?

- A. Credential dumping
- B. Encryption
- C. Hash collision
- D. Tokenization

16. Which attack targets a specific person using personalized information?

- A. Phishing
- B. Spear phishing
- C. Smishing
- D. Vishing

17. What does SIEM primarily do?

- A. Develop malware
- B. Log collection and analysis
- C. Block internet traffic
- D. Replace antivirus

18. What security concept ensures data has not been altered?

- A. Confidentiality
- B. Integrity
- C. Availability
- D. Authorization

19. Which protocol is commonly used for remote desktop access?

- A. FTP
- B. RDP
- C. SMTP
- D. DNS

20. Which authentication method requires more than one factor?

- A. Single factor

- B. Multi-factor authentication
- C. Password authentication
- D. Tokenization

21. What is alert triage?

- A. Ignoring alerts
- B. Investigating and prioritizing alerts
- C. Deleting logs
- D. Disabling SIEM

22. What type of privilege escalation increases privilege level?

- A. Horizontal
- B. Vertical
- C. Internal
- D. Passive

23. What does Event ID 4625 indicate?

- A. Successful login
- B. Failed login
- C. Account deletion
- D. Password reset

24. Which attack involves creating a fake WiFi access point?

- A. Evil Twin
- B. Pharming
- C. Smishing
- D. Tailgating

25. Which SOC process analyzes alerts to determine if they are threats?

- A. Alert triage
- B. Encryption
- C. Data backup
- D. Software patching

Answer Key with Explanations

1. What is the primary role of a SOC L1 analyst?

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: SOC L1 analysts mainly monitor security alerts, validate them, and escalate incidents when necessary.

2. Which malware encrypts files and demands payment?

Correct Answer: C

Explanation: Ransomware encrypts files and demands payment for decryption.

3. Which attack uses one password across many accounts?

Correct Answer: C

Explanation: Password spraying tries one common password across many accounts to avoid lockouts.

4. What does hashing primarily provide?

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: Hashing ensures data integrity by producing a unique fingerprint of data.

5. What does salting prevent?

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: Salting randomizes hashes so rainbow tables cannot be used.

6. Which tool is commonly used for credential dumping?

Correct Answer: C

Explanation: Mimikatz extracts passwords and hashes from memory.

7. Which Windows process stores credentials in memory?

Correct Answer: C

Explanation: LSASS manages authentication and stores credential information.

8. Which attack redirects users to a fake website without clicking a malicious link?

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: Pharming manipulates DNS to redirect legitimate traffic.

9. Moving from one compromised machine to another inside a network is called?

Correct Answer: C

Explanation: Lateral movement occurs when attackers pivot internally to other systems.

10. Which encryption type uses two keys?

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: Asymmetric encryption uses public and private keys.

11. Which attack involves fraudulent emails to steal credentials?

Correct Answer: A

Explanation: Phishing uses deceptive emails to steal user credentials.

12. What does IOC stand for?

Correct Answer: A

Explanation: IOC refers to evidence that suggests a security breach.

13. Which attack uses previously leaked credentials from breaches?

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: Credential stuffing uses stolen username/password combinations.

14. Which attack floods servers with traffic to disrupt services?

Correct Answer: C

Explanation: DDoS overwhelms systems with traffic.

15. Which technique steals password hashes from memory?

Correct Answer: A

Explanation: Credential dumping extracts stored credentials from system memory.

16. Which attack targets a specific person using personalized information?

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: Spear phishing is a targeted phishing attack.

17. What does SIEM primarily do?

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: SIEM collects, correlates and analyzes logs.

18. What security concept ensures data has not been altered?

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: Integrity ensures data remains unchanged.

19. Which protocol is commonly used for remote desktop access?

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: RDP enables remote Windows system access.

20. Which authentication method requires more than one factor?

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: MFA requires multiple verification methods.

21. What is alert triage?

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: Alert triage evaluates alerts to determine if they are real threats.

22. What type of privilege escalation increases privilege level?

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: Vertical escalation increases privilege (user to admin).

23. What does Event ID 4625 indicate?

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: Windows Event ID 4625 indicates a failed login attempt.

24. Which attack involves creating a fake WiFi access point?

Correct Answer: A

Explanation: Evil Twin attacks impersonate legitimate WiFi networks.

25. Which SOC process analyzes alerts to determine if they are threats?

Correct Answer: A

Explanation: Alert triage is the first step in SOC investigation.